



THE GAP IN BETWEEN · STARTUP CHALLENGE 2026 · SOCIAL NEST FOUNDATION

Trusted housing access on WhatsApp.

Casa Cameroon is an AI-powered, WhatsApp-first marketplace that makes renting safer and faster — then turns the same user network into community infrastructure for cleaner cities.

Social innovation · PropTech · AI SDG 11 · 8 · 9 · 12 Seeking €10,000

PROBLEM

Informal housing search locks people out of safe urban opportunity.

Who is affected

Tenants (22–40) and landlords (30–55) in Douala, Yaoundé and other Cameroon cities — plus small businesses seeking commercial space.

What goes wrong

Word of mouth, brokers and Facebook groups waste time and money. Fake or rented-out listings. Unverified landlords. Empty units. No trust layer.

Why it matters at scale

~60% of Cameroonians live in cities; urban growth ~3.6%/year. Rental demand is strong because ownership is unaffordable for many (CAHF). Discovery still runs on informal channels while people already live on WhatsApp — but refuse heavy new apps on slow internet.

SOLUTION

A full housing marketplace inside WhatsApp.

List

Landlords verify ID, add GPS, photos and a mandatory property video. EN/FR.

Search

Tenants search by neighbourhood, category or natural language – residential or commercial.

Unlock

Pay 5,000 XAF (~€7.60) once per listing to get the landlord contact and map link.

NO NEW APP

AI-ASSISTED

ID + VIDEO TRUST

MOBILE MONEY PATH

BILINGUAL CAMEROON

Innovation: distribution-first PropTech – product where behaviour already is, trust where informal markets fail.

Find and rent on WhatsApp – verified, bilingual, no download.

Alternatives

- Facebook groups – noisy, unverified
- Street brokers – opaque, limited reach
- Native apps – install friction, heavy data
- Agencies – slow/costly for mass market

Casa differentiation

- Full product in WhatsApp chat
- AI listing + search understanding
- ID verification + mandatory videos
- Built for slow networks & EN/FR Cameroon

Social impact now. Environmental infrastructure next.

Social (primary)

Safer housing access, less fraud, faster moves for families and small businesses, fairer landlord-tenant matching.

KPIs:

verified listings %, flagged/fake rate, successful unlocks, users in target cities.

Environmental (phase 2)

Same WhatsApp user database coordinates neighbourhood **waste sorting & collection**

– schedules, guidance, participation.

KPIs:

neighbourhoods piloted, messages delivered, participation rate.

SDG 11 CITIES

SDG 8 DECENT WORK

SDG 9 INNOVATION

SDG 12 RESPONSIBLE CONSUMPTION

Impact evolution: early stage – product live, first users/unlock. Next quarters focus on density + measurable unlock and trust KPIs.

Cameroon beachhead. Francophone Africa expansion.

Operating country

Cameroon

— Douala & Yaoundé first, then Bamenda. Paying ICP: urban tenants; supply: landlords with 1–10 units; secondary: small agents.

Market potential

Large informal rental economy + high WhatsApp usage + Mobile Money rails. Same pattern repeats in Côte d'Ivoire, Senegal, Gabon and peers.

GTM

Landlord-first seeding → Facebook “maison à louer” groups → WhatsApp conversion → referrals & agents → paid social once CAC proven. Bootstrap target ~€800/month ops.

Marketplace unlock fees. Free to list.

Revenue streams

- Tenant unlock: 5,000 XAF (~€7.60) / listing
- Agent commission: 15% of unlock
- Landlords list free (grow supply)
- Future: featured listings / subscriptions

Unit economics (estimate)

- Cash CAC today: €0 (organic)
- Est. paid CAC: ~€9-10 / user
- Est. LTV: ~€23 (~\$25)
- Revenue type: 100% one-time today

€8

Revenue last 12 months

€0

ARR (no subscriptions yet)

No

Positive EBITDA yet

8

Users · 1 unlock

Live in production. TRL 7. Honest early numbers.

Product live

WhatsApp Cloud API marketplace, AI flows, ID + video trust, admin + marketing site on Railway.

Users

8 registered (1 landlord, 7 tenants). First unlock completed. Organic social live.

Architecture

Hybrid web/worker, Postgres, Redis durable queue, bilingual EN/FR, MoMo path next.

Performance KPIs we track

Active listings · Paid unlocks · Registered users · Search → unlock conversion · Flagged listing rate

Founder-built. Shipping. Ready for growth hire.

Nkwain Nobert Ekfuingei

Founder & Developer · 1 founder · 1 collaborator

Built Casa end-to-end and launched in production. Women in founding team: 0%. Next hire: Sales/Growth Lead (EN/FR).

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Accountability

- Weekly KPI scorecard
- Weekly acquisition targets
- Monthly OKR-style review
- External mentor commits

Scale density → payments → cities → community impact.

M1-2

MTN MoMo + Orange Money; first paid unlocks

M3-6

Douala/Yaoundé density; agents + referrals; sales playbook

M7-9

3rd city; ops break-even path

M10-12

Waste-outreach pilot; Francophone expansion prep

3-5 year vision

Default WhatsApp housing layer for Cameroon's major cities, then Francophone Africa – with community services (waste coordination) on the same trusted network. Market transformation: informal rental becomes searchable, fair and safe.

Capital to grow. Mentors to learn. Network to scale.

Funding

Raised to date:

€0

(bootstrapped).

Looking for:

€10,000

for marketing + burn rate while we validate repeatable acquisition.

What GIB unlocks for us

- Visibility with impact investors & corporates
- Mentorship on sales / GTM
- Connections with founders across countries
- Stage to pitch internationally (Valencia)

Barriers we are addressing

Sales capacity · supply/demand balance · Mobile Money go-live · trust at scale · marketing capital — solved via hire/playbook, landlord-first seeding, payments wiring, moderation stack, and this €10k raise.



CLOSE THE GAP BETWEEN INFORMAL HOUSING AND TRUSTED ACCESS

Casa – Find your home on WhatsApp.

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Seeking €10,000 · Mentorship · Founder network · Impact partnerships